

Try Out TestLink, a Test Management Tool

This article explores the benefits of TestLink, a comprehensive test management tool, which can manage the whole testing process in any organisation.



Managing a test cycle can be as exhausting as managing a production cycle. The test cycle has many phases, and each phase is based on either incremental or full testing. In spite of the hectic schedules and stringent market timings, companies have realised the importance of testing products. It has now become more important than ever to simplify the testing process and, at the same time, make it comprehensive.

When testing a product, it is quite challenging to manage a complete cycle. This includes the mapping of requirements for test cases, release management, assignment of test cases to testers, tracking the test cycle, proper filing of bugs and report generation.

There are many test management tools available in the market but the one free, open source tool that caught our attention was TestLink. It is quite a powerful tool with a variety of features and allows customisation as per your requirements.

TestLink as a test management tool

TestLink is a Web-based open source test management tool that facilitates a complete quality assurance cycle, right from requirements to release. This tool offers support for the management of requirements, linking of requirements to test cases, user management, the assignment and execution of the test cases, and has an interface to give detailed reports and statistics.

TestLink helps to keep the test process under control. It

forms a repository for requirements and test cases, and relates these to builds, platforms and resources. Tests are assigned to resources or testers who execute them and update the results. A wide variety of reports provide information on what has been done and

what still needs to be done for a particular build in a project.

Any company that has tests and test cases can use this tool to effectively manage the whole test process. This tool can easily and effectively replace the Excel sheets and document files used to prepare the test cases and test reports. As it is centralised, the status can be updated and shared on a daily basis.

Installation and configuration of TestLink

TestLink is based on PHP with the database support of MySQL and PostgreSQL. It's a completely free and open source project and has the support of various bug trackers like Bugzilla, Mantis and Jira. TestLink is Web-based and hence needs a Web server, database and PHP support. The basic installation steps are given below (for Linux Fedora 14).

Download the latest TestLink version from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/testlink/>. Download the XAMPP package, which has the Apache Web server and the MySQL database from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/xampp/>.

Extract the downloaded XAMPP archive file to the `/opt` location using the following command:

```
tar xvfz xampp-linux-1.8.1.tar.gz -C /opt
```

- Now the XAMPP package will get installed in the `/opt/`